YOUR MAGAZINE FROM GALLIONS

thamesview

NEWS • EVENTS • COMPETITIONS

JANUARY 2012
www.gallionsha.co.uk



FREE TRAINING IN WORD PROCESSING, HORTICULTURE, BASIC SKILLS

SUPPORT YOUR LOCAL FOODBANK IN 2012

BECOME A RESIDENT AUDITOR!

Gallions Housing Association

CONTENTS

















WITH THIS ISSUE: YOUR FREE GUIDE TO SAVING ENERGY AND MONEY!

WELCOME

Happy New Year! In this edition there are lots of things to keep you busy in 2012; from great free training courses, lots of opportunities to get involved with Gallions and the chance to give something back to your community.

This year will also see the arrival of the Olympics, the Queen's Diamond Jubilee celebrations and the launch of Greenwich as a Royal Borough. I hope you enjoy it all and have a happy and healthy 2012.

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Gallions Residents Group
Gallions Housing Association

FANTASTIC FOODBANKS



13 million people live below the poverty line in the UK and every day people go hungry because of family breakdown, poor health, benefit delays and many other reasons. Trussell Trust foodbanks provide a minimum of three days emergency food and support to people experiencing crisis. They need food donations to continue supplying their service so buy an item from this shopping list during your next supermarket trip and donate it.

"Pick up something extra in the supermarket for families that really need it"

Milk (UHT or powdered)
Sugar (500g)
Fruit juice (carton)
Soup
Pasta sauces
Sponge pudding (tinned)
Tomatoes (tinned)
Cereals
Rice pudding (tinned)
Tea Bags/instant coffee
Instant mash potato
Rice/pasta
Tinned meat/fish
Tinned fruit
Jam
Biscuits or snack bars

You can donate your items at:
Thamesmead Foodbank, Emmanuel Church, Yarnton Way, Erith, DA18 4DR
Tower Hamlets Foodbank, 302 The Highway, Shadwell, London, E1W 3DH
Newham Foodbank, St Marks Centre, 218 Tollgate Road, Beckton, London, E6 5YA

Your local foodbank is also looking for volunteers and funding to help run the service; contact them directly if you can help. If you would like to get an emergency foodbox speak to your social worker, health visitor, doctor or local citizens advice bureau. For more information about the service visit www.trusselltrust.org or call 01722 411244.

RESIDENT AUDITORS GET STARTED

"Help us make our services better"

Last year some of our residents volunteered to become Resident Auditors. In their new role they inspect our services and make recommendations for change and improvement.

One of the Resident Auditors told us:

"After some rigorous training and many cups of coffee, we were armed and ready to complete our first audit. This took place in November and we worked closely with staff from Axis and Gallions to investigate the repairs reporting and appointments service. We will discuss our findings with the Gallions Residents Group and make recommendations to improve the service. This scheme is fun, it's very worthwhile and it gives us, as residents, the chance to identify service weaknesses and make positive changes."

If you would like to learn some new skills, make friends and help us improve what we do get in touch with Marie Dunster on 0300 123 1237 or email mdunster@gallionsha.co.uk. We will be running a taster day for potential new Resident Auditors in February/March. We give our Resident Auditors a £100 voucher for each audit they successfully complete.



CLICK YOUR WAY TO A QUALIFICATION!

"Free training in word processing"



We are working with ARC Training, Education & Community Services to offer 12 of our residents the chance to have Beginner's Word Processing Training for free! This is an accredited course that can lead to an eDCC qualification at foundation level. Free training in CV writing, interview skills and job search techniques will also be available to everyone who signs up. To apply you should be:

- Aged 16+
- Unemployed and looking for work
- Ready to start in April 2012 and able to commit to training for 2 hours per week for 12 weeks
- Able to get to the study centre in Abbey Wood

Contact Kelly Sullivan on 0300 123 1237 or email ksullivan@gallionsha.co.uk to reserve your place by 20 February 2012. The course will take place at 34-36 Grovebury Road, Abbey Wood, London, SE2 9BB.

ARC TEC SERVICES
THE ALTERNATIVE QUALITY TRAINING & EDUCATION PROVIDER IN THE BOROUGH



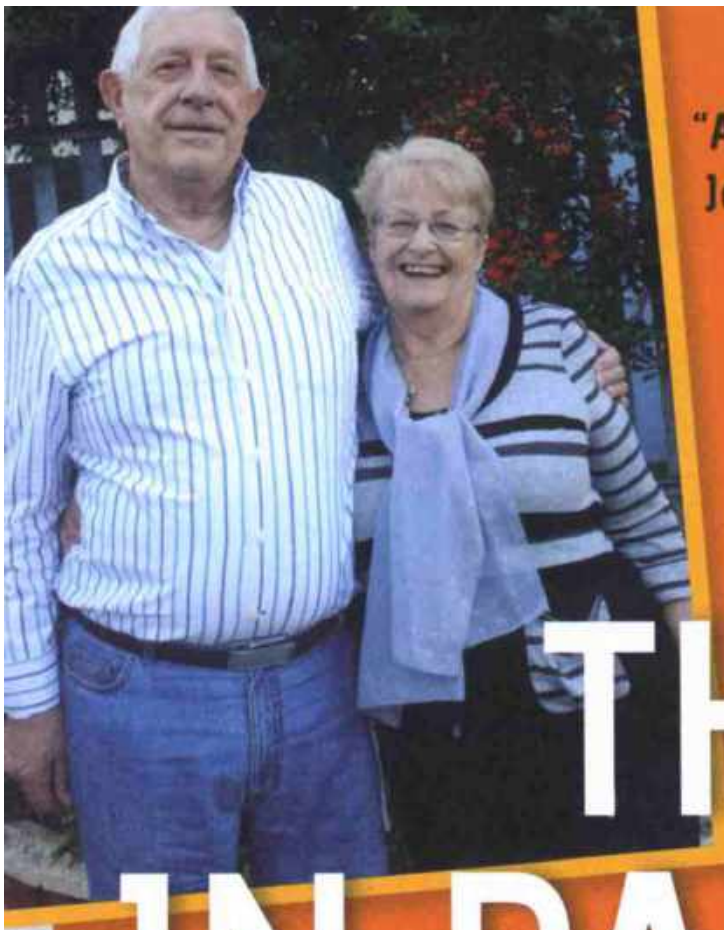
HAVE YOUR SAY ABOUT OUR REPAIRS, MAINTENANCE AND IMPROVEMENTS SERVICE

"Join our focus group"

We will be reviewing our Asset Management Strategy during 2012 and we need your help! The strategy sets out what we plan to invest in repairs, maintenance and improvements to our homes and neighbourhoods in the short, medium and long term. We would like to hear your views about what your priorities are so we can consider them when deciding what our future strategy will be.

If you are interested in joining the focus group, contact Marie Dunster on 0300 123 1237 or email mdunster@gallionsha.co.uk.





"A day in the life of John Thompson"

ALL ABOUT THE POP IN PARLOUR

The Pop in Parlour at Evenlode House is a great meeting place for older people. It is open Monday to Friday, 10am-2.30pm. Wonderful lunches are served every day and they also have a bowling green and bingo on Fridays. Here we met the Chair John.

What do you do at the Pop in Parlour?

I have worked at the parlour for 15 years. I started as a 'washer upper' when my wife Pat worked at a parlour in Orpington. I am the chair person and manager of all activities at the Pop in Parlour, including arranging outings, parties and the day to day running of things.

Why should people come along?

The atmosphere is so friendly; nothing is too much trouble for anyone and everybody mixes together. We even do our bit for the community; last year volunteers from the parlour manned the poppy stall at Morrisons. We even have visitors from Crayford and Bexley which shows just how enjoyable the parlour is! We are also the only parlour to have a three star rating in hygiene.

Do you have any favourite moments?

My favourite trip was a five day stay at Warners on Hayling Island. Everyone enjoyed it. There were great evening shows, bowls and croquet. Many of our members wouldn't be able to go on their own, but they feel safe with us and know we will look after them and make sure they have a great time!

To find out more information call John on 020 8310 7437 or visit www.ageuk.org.uk/bexley.

NEW YEAR, NEW SKILLS!

"Learn about growing your own vegetables"



"Working together to manage migration"
Actions co-financed by the European Fund for the Integration of Third Country Nationals

TRUST. THAMESMEAD

GROUNDWORK
CHANGING PLACES
CHANGING LIVES

- Are you interested in growing your own vegetables? Groundwork London is helping community groups to set up new community gardens across Thamesmead for everyone to enjoy. Come along to the first community garden in Birchmere Park (next to the old one o' clock club, behind Cole Close) every Thursday morning from 10am to find out more.
- Do you want to gain accredited qualifications in gardening and horticulture? If you join the Groundwork London Green Team, you will receive both 'on the job' and accredited training in a wide variety of gardening and horticulture skills.
- Would you like to attend literacy, numeracy or ESOL classes and gain recognised qualifications? Classes are available for Thamesmead residents on Mondays, Fridays and Saturdays at the Arnott Community Centre, Arnott Close, off Titmuss Avenue. Classes opening in West Thamesmead soon!

To find out more email or call Sarah Smith from Groundwork London at sarah.smith@groundwork.org.uk or 020 7922 1230.

AFFORDABLE RENTS AND FLEXIBLE TENANCIES: NEW FOR 2012

This year we will be introducing some new types of tenancy agreements.

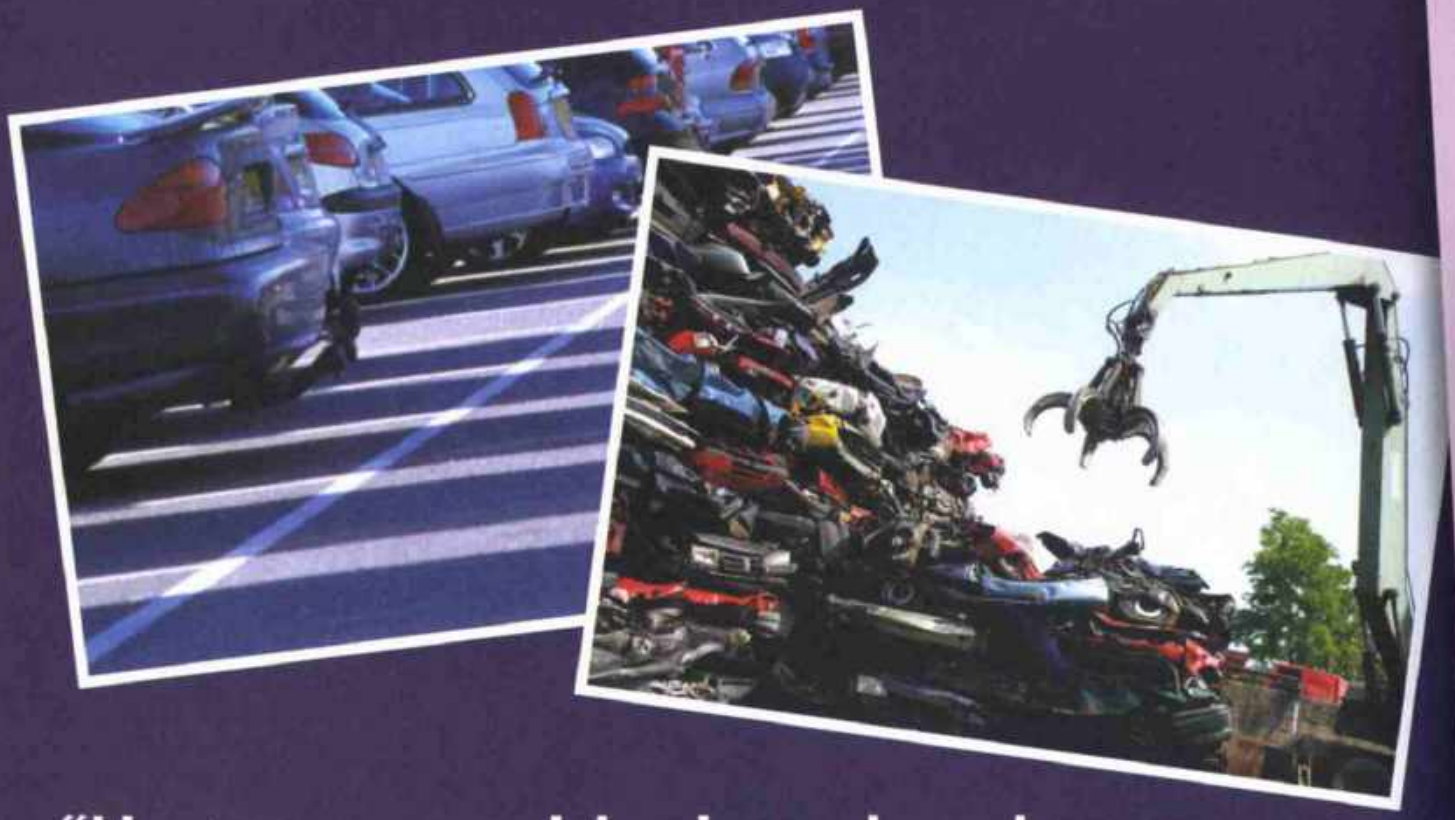
Flexible Tenancies: This tenancy has been introduced by the government to make the housing system more flexible and help people to be housed properly. A flexible tenancy will last for a minimum of five years. Existing tenants won't be affected and they will keep their lifetime tenancy.

Affordable Rents: From 2012 we will rent some of our properties at up to 80% of the usual market rent. These tenancies will be either on a lifetime basis or for the flexible term of 5 years (minimum). If you are an existing tenant you won't be affected unless you move home. If you transfer you may be offered an Affordable Rent property but you will keep your lifetime tenancy.

All new tenancies from April 2012 will either be Affordable Flexible, Social Flexible, Affordable Lifetime or Social Lifetime.

To find out more visit www.direct.gov.uk or call us on 0300 123 1237.

KEEPING YOUR CAR ON THE ROAD THIS YEAR



"Your car must be taxed and insured if it's in a communal car park"

If you have a vehicle that you park in a public parking area owned by Gallions you must make sure it is insured and taxed at all times.

If you don't have valid tax and insurance you could:

- Receive a fixed penalty fine of £100
- Have your vehicle clamped, impounded or crushed
- Face a court prosecution with a maximum fine of £1000

Even if you have a SORN (Statutory Off Road Notification) you could still be fined and clamped if you park in a Gallions communal car park.

The SORN only applies if you park on a private driveway or in a garage.

We will also remove abandoned vehicles from Gallions' public parking areas.

To find out more visit www.direct.gov.uk or call the DVLA on 0300 790 6802.

USING CCTV IN OUR COMMUNITIES

"CCTV helps us deal with crime and anti-social behaviour"





We have CCTV in our neighbourhoods to help protect our residents; we use the images when we investigate your reports of anti-social behaviour or when a crime has taken place and the police ask us to provide our footage. Our CCTV images have recently been used to identify those involved in:

- Robberies
- An arson attack
- A Grevious Bodily Harm case
- Urinating in the lifts
- Damaging public areas
- Incorrect disposal of rubbish

We continue to improve the quality of our cameras and recording equipment so that the images are of the best quality. If you see a crime taking place please report it to the police and we will supply our CCTV footage to them if they request it.

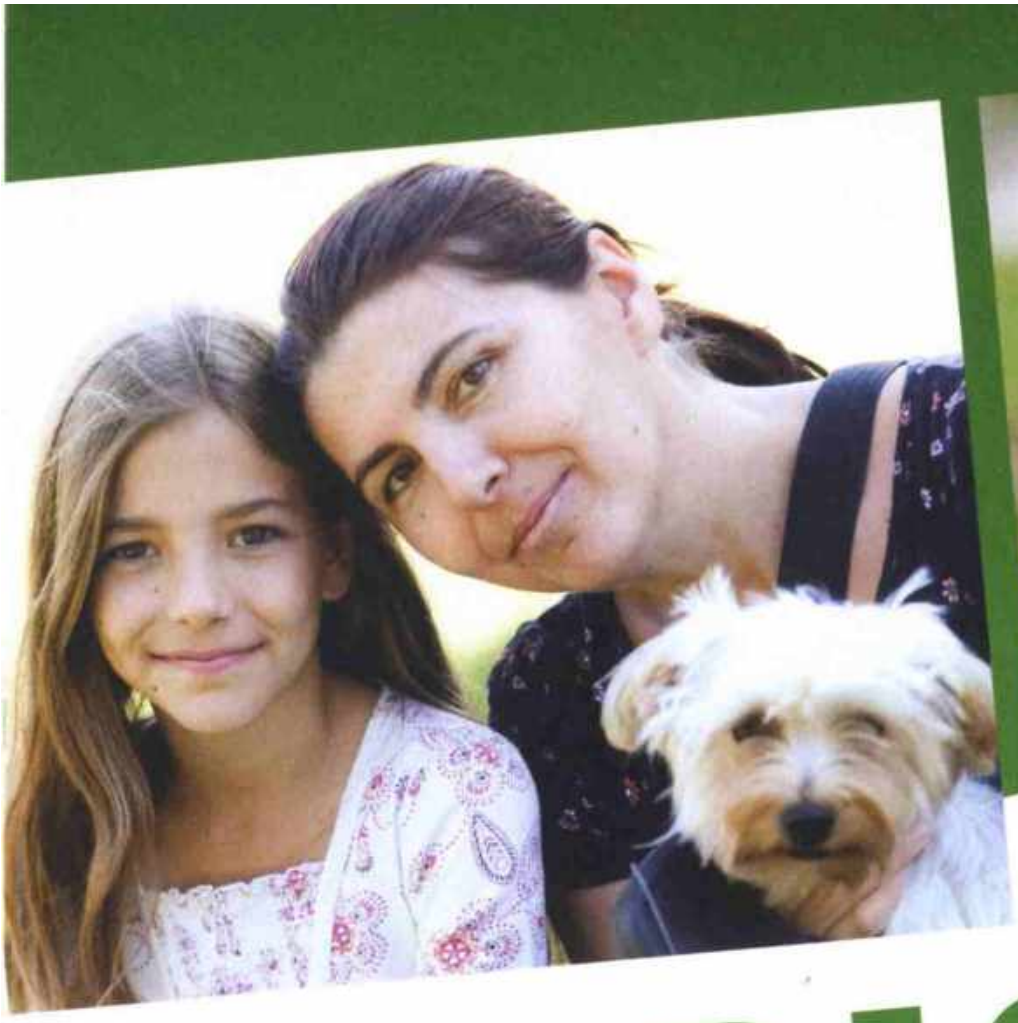
DEALING WITH DOMESTIC VIOLENCE

"Contact us if you need advice and support"

Domestic violence normally includes any incident of threatening behaviour, violence or abuse (psychological, physical, sexual, financial or emotional) between adults who are or have been in a relationship.

If you are experiencing domestic violence or are worried about a friend or neighbour you can contact:

- Us on 0300 123 1237; we will give you advice, put you in touch with local agencies that can help or contact them on your behalf.
- The 24 hour National Domestic Violence Helpline - 0800 2000 247
- Bexley Domestic Violence Crisis Intervention Team - 0800 731 7860
- Bexley Women's Aid - 020 8301 1536
- Greenwich Women's Aid - 020 8317 8273
- Greenwich Police Community Safety Unit - 020 8284 9865
- Tower Hamlets Refuge - 020 7858 6500
- Newham Action Against Domestic Violence - 020 7473 3047
- In an emergency, always call the Police on 999





MAKE A BIG DIFFERENCE TO A YOUNG PERSON'S LIFE IN 2012



"Greenwich Council is looking for new foster carers"

Foster carers make a difference to the lives of hundreds of children and young people, by caring for them in their own home - either until difficulties within their family are resolved and the child returns home, or until a long-term placement is found. By becoming a foster carer you would be helping children in Greenwich to stay within their borough, keeping their friends, school and a familiar environment.

The children and young people range in age from newborn babies through to teenagers. Greenwich Council takes every care to ensure that carers and children are well matched according to nationality, ethnicity and the particular strengths of the carers and needs of the child.

Foster carers can be single, divorced or in a couple. They must be aged 25 or over. All ethnicities are encouraged to come forward as foster carers.

You will need to be able to commit full-time to supporting the child at home, and will need to have a spare room available.

Foster carers get plenty of support, training and receive a weekly allowance.

To find out more about fostering in Greenwich visit www.greenwich.gov.uk/fostering or call free on 0800 052 1499.

GET READY FOR THE OLYMPICS

A new year always calls for a fresh start and with the Olympics what better motivation do you need to get out, get fit and have fun.

Walk

Grab a pair of trainers and just get going. With loads of fabulous walks around London you'll be spoilt for choice. Check out www.greenchain.com to find a route to suit you.

Run

Get your heart pumping and improve your muscle strength by taking up running. Best of all it's cheap and you can do it whenever you have time! If you don't want to run on your own join a running group or get a friend involved for added motivation! The local parks are a great place to start - just make sure you have proper running shoes.

Cycle

Getting on your bike will not only get you fit but it could help your piggy bank too. Start by saving your bus fare or petrol and cycle to the local shops. Visit www.tfl.gov.uk/cycling to find out more about cycling routes in London.

Sail

Canoeing and kayaking are fantastic options if you don't mind getting wet and want to learn something completely different. There are many boating clubs around the Thames but if you are south of the river then visit www.southmereboating.co.uk for more information.

"Try a new sport or exercise and beat the winter blues!"





Swim

Great for toning the whole body and excellent for a cardiovascular workout, swimming has it all. Head to your local leisure centre, where some local authorities offer free swims for under 16s and over 60s. Visit www.gll.org to see what's on offer in your borough. In the summer try the Serpentine Lido and Paddling Pool at Hyde Park. There are concessions for children and those on a low income. Visit www.royalparks.org.uk for opening times and prices.

Dance

From ballet to ballroom there's something for everyone with dancing. Afternoon tea dances are a brilliant way to try out a mix of Jive, Ballroom and Sequence dancing for some good old-fashioned fun. Visit www.greenwichdance.org.uk or www.ragrooftheatre.co.uk for more info about local tea dances.

Zumba

This is the latest craze to hit the UK. With the mix of fast beats, loud music and quick dance moves you'll be feeling the Zumba heat in no time. Find your local class at www.zumba.com

Fitness DVDs

If you're short on time then why not try a DVD at home. Check out www.amazon.co.uk for some good bargains. Our DVD favourites are Billy Blank's, Tae Bo and Davina McCall, Davina Fit.

DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

BROADWATER GREEN TREE PLANTING

WEST THAMESMEAD

11 February >> 11am - 3pm >> Free

www.treesforcities.org >> 0207 840 5952

CHINESE NEW YEAR FAMILY CELEBRATIONS

NATIONAL MARITIME MUSEUM | GREENWICH

18 February >> 11am - 6pm >> Free

www.greenwich.gov.uk >> 020 8858 4422

POP-UP DICKENSIAN DOCKLANDS

CELEBRATING 200 YEARS OF CHARLES DICKENS

Museum of London at Docklands

25 February >> 12.30pm - 2.30pm >> Free

www.museumoflondon.org.uk >> 020 7001 9844

ST PATRICK'S DAY PARADE

STARTS AT PICCADILLY | CENTRAL LONDON

18 March >> From 12pm >> Free

www.visitlondon.com >> 08701 566 366

Z	N	X	R	A	T	V	R	B	H	T	T	M
D	J	F	K	T	G	H	P	J	O	K	R	L
G	C	F	X	H	G	S	A	A	I	Z	I	X
S	T	A	K	L	U	W	N	E	B	G	A	T
U	I	I	Y	E	R	C	W	L	M	N	T	U
Z	P	R	O	T	R	F	E	R	W	I	H	S
C	Y	C	L	I	N	G	E	T	I	V	L	U
B	A	N	Y	C	W	P	E	O	G	I	O	G
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O	M	P	N	L	B	K	B	J	V	H	C	W
Q	A	E	O	R	D	T	O	D	U	J	A	O
Z	P	X	N	C	M	V	Q	B	E	N	F	R

WIN WITH OUR WORDSEARCH

The Olympics will be coming to London this year so in this wordsearch we have hidden the names of six popular Olympic sports. Find them all and you could win a £30 shopping voucher.

ATHLETICS
CYCLING
DIVING
JUDO
ROWING
TRIATHLON

DID YOU KNOW...

The Olympic Park is the size of 357 football pitches. 7.6 million tickets have been sold for the Olympics and there will be 10,500 athletes taking part in 26 different sports. Around 900,000 items of sports equipment will be needed for the games.

Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Anita Glover, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 28th February 2012. The winner will be selected at random.

Name:

Address:

Telephone:

Email:

Congratulations to Diane Lees of Livesey Close who was the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

Tenants view...

New Year. New start. New members. The Gallions Residents Group (GRG) is looking forward to the year ahead now as a larger group. This means we will work harder to scrutinise and improve Gallions services and plan some community activities. Watch this space!

Gallions Residents Group update

The GRG are four months into their new role as a scrutiny group. We now have more regular meetings and look at specific services in more detail so we can challenge Gallions more about the work they do and improve homes and neighbourhoods for residents.

The group has nine members:

Deborah Frimpong (Chair), Joanne Bernard (Vice Chair), Sheila Fagg, Con Lobo, Michael Pavis, Cherry Kent, Marlene Hunter, Kath Broadway and George Ameyaw.

Deborah Frimpong told us:

"The current economic climate means that many of us are concerned about how the government policy changes will affect our lifestyles and communities in the future. However, these are not times for us to give up and fold our hands; there are still opportunities for us to make a positive impact in our neighbourhoods. Let's continue to get involved in some way or another with Gallions and take our chance to make a difference!"

If you would like to get involved with the GRG please contact Helen Chambers on 0300 123 1237 or email hchambers@gallionsha.co.uk

Things to be proud of



This year there will be lots of good things happening where you live. Along with the Olympics coming to London, Greenwich will become a royal borough in 2012 to commemorate the Queen's Diamond Jubilee. Make sure you celebrate with your friends and neighbours.

Find out about your MP

If you would like to know who your MP is, how to contact them and a bit more about how they represent your community then logon to www.theyworkforyou.com. All you need to do is enter your postcode!

Update from Axis



The Resident Auditors recently met with Axis to discuss the repairs service at Gallions. Axis explained that they had improved their call handling since the dedicated Repairs Contact Team number was set up in April.

In October 2011 the team answered 83 % of calls within 20 seconds and only 2.5 % of callers hung up before they got through to a member of the team. To report a repair call 0300 123 1238 or visit www.gallionsha.co.uk to tell us about non-urgent repairs in your home or block.

Improvements at Gallions Reach Park

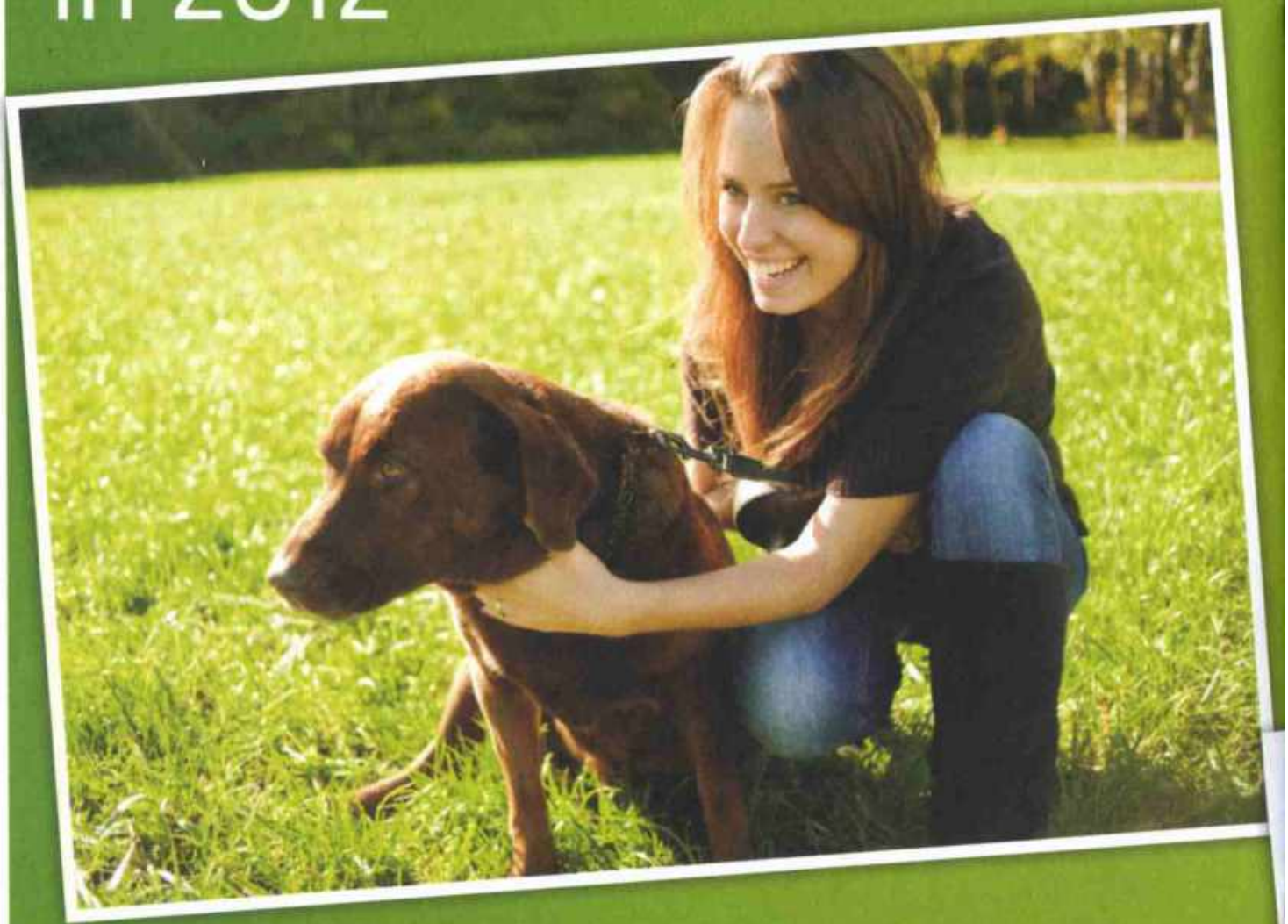


Tilfen Land has been carrying out lots of work to improve the open spaces in West Thamesmead. Gallions Reach Park, which links Gallions Hill to the riverside, will provide a fantastic space that residents of all ages can enjoy.

Once the project is completed there will be new cycle and footpaths, look-out points over the river, thousands of new trees, plants and much more. We will keep you updated on the progress of the park in future editions of Tenants View.

Tenants view...

Keep our streets clean in 2012



If you are a dog owner make one important resolution this new year - to clean up after your pet and help keep your community clean. Leaving dog mess behind is a health risk to other people and really unpleasant for your neighbours. Always use the bins provided or carry bags and take the mess home with you.

If you don't clean up after your dog you can be issued with a Fixed Penalty Notice, or if the case goes to court a fine of up to £1000.

Contact Gallions on 0300 123 1237 or your local council if you are concerned about dog fouling in your area.

Street drinking in the Moorings



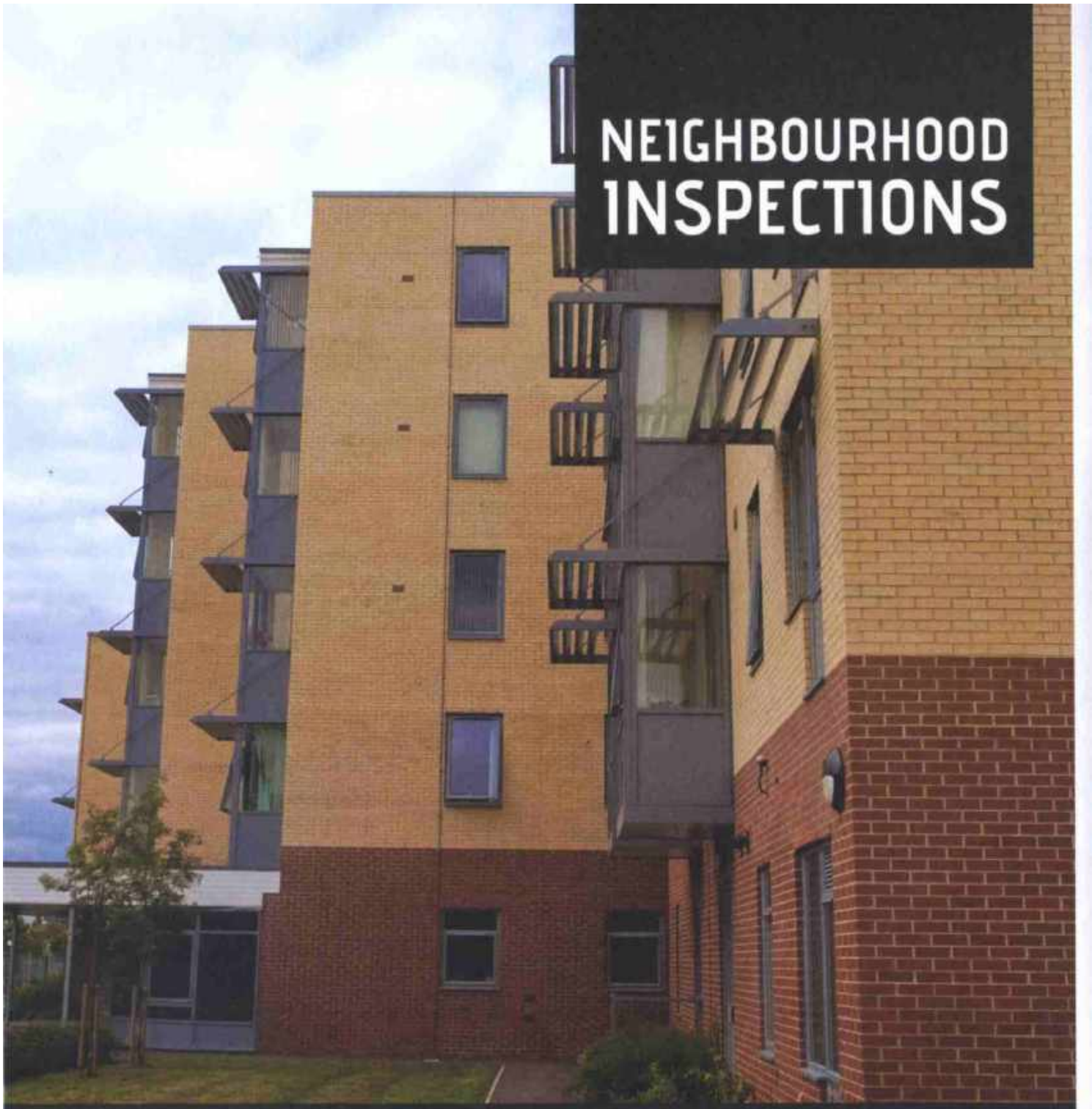
Residents have been concerned about street drinking and anti-social behaviour near the Arnott Close shops in Thamesmead for some time.



The following steps have recently been taken to improve the area for residents:

- Gallions has given out more than 600 surveys to local residents to find out their views and ideas for improvement
- Gallions has met with the street drinkers that are tenants and offered advice, given first warnings and served tenancy notices as appropriate
- The Gallions Wardens patrol the area daily and check CCTV footage to identify street drinkers
- Greenwich Council has introduced and maintained a Controlled Drinking Zone around the shops so police can confiscate alcohol from those who are behaving anti-socially.
- The local off licence has changed it's licensing hours so that alcohol can't be served until after 11am

If you are concerned about street drinking or other anti-social behaviour please contact Gallions on 0300 123 1237 or the police non-emergency service on 101.

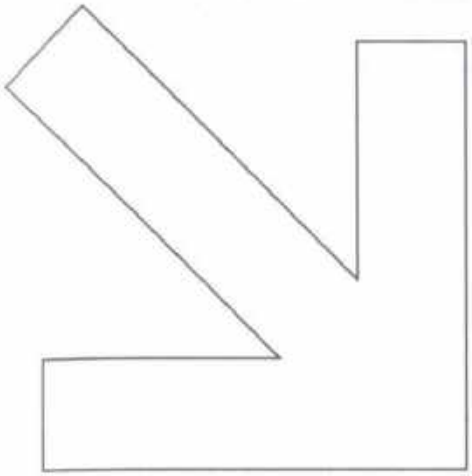


NEIGHBOURHOOD INSPECTIONS

Join our Neighbourhood Wardens at the next Neighbourhood Inspection near you! You will be able to discuss issues in your area including:

- Graffiti
- Littering
- Dog fouling
- Unmaintained gardens
- Abandoned vehicles

If your neighbourhood isn't listed here but you'd like the Wardens to visit call us on 0300 123 1237. If you live in a flat your caretaker will inspect the areas inside your block - just chat to them if you have any issues.



THURSDAY 2 FEBRUARY 2012 - OLD CHURCH COURT

Meet Frank Smith by the entry gate to the car park at 2pm.

TUESDAY 7 FEBRUARY 2012 - MANORWAY

Meet Chris Waite at the junction between Goldcrest Close and Whimbrel Close at 2pm.

THURSDAY 16 FEBRUARY 2012 - SOUTHMERE

Meet Steve Hayzen at the junction between Hartslock Drive and Portmeadow Walk at 2pm.

TUESDAY 21 FEBRUARY 2012 - WATERFIELD

Meet Phil Briggs at the junction between Byron Close and Owen Close at 2pm.

TUESDAY 6 MARCH, 2012 - BROADWATERS

Meet Chris Waite at the junction between Whinchat Road and Wigeon Path at 2pm.

TUESDAY 13 MARCH 2012 - MOORINGS

Meet Phil Briggs at the junction between Titmuss Avenue and Booth Close at 2pm.

THURSDAY 15 MARCH, 2012 - GREENMEAD

Meet Steve Hayzen in Lime Row near the Post Office at 2pm.

THURSDAY 29 MARCH, 2012 - ST JOSEPHS

Meet Frank Smith in the car park at 2pm.





HOW WELL ARE WE DOING?

This performance chart shows our performance as a landlord during the 2011 financial year compared to 2010. If you would like to join our residents group and help us monitor and improve what we do please contact Helen Chambers on 0300 123 1237.





Description	2010/11	2011/12	Target	Performance Trend	Current Status
Overall satisfaction with service	82%	82%	75%	↔	☺
Void re-let period (a lower figure is better)	30 days	26 days	26 days	↑	☺
Emergency repairs completed within timescale	99%	99%	98%	↔	☺
Calls answered within 20 seconds (Customer Contact Team)	83%	86%	80%	↑	☺
Calls answered within 20 seconds (Repairs Contact Team)	N/A	75%	80%	N/A	☹
Complaints answered within timescale	90%	98%	90%	↑	☺
Satisfaction with anti-social behaviour process	91%	88%	84%	↓	☺
Rent collected	99%	99%	100%	↔	☹

Performance Status			Overall Performance Trend
☹	Performance is below target	↑	Performance is better than last year
☺	Performance is above target	↓	Performance is worse than last year
		↔	Performance is the same as last year

HOMEOWNER NEWS

Homeowner Consultation Panel

The Homeowner Consultation Panel is a new group made up of members who represent freeholders, leaseholders and shared owners. They met twice in 2011 and as with other residents groups, the minutes and any action points from meetings are passed to the Gallions Resident Group (GRG) Scrutiny Committee to help them monitor the quality of Gallions services. So far the group has discussed:

- Service and estate charges
- Improvements to information provided on invoices
- The recent large bills for major works
- Consultation and the need to ensure value for money
- How procurement decisions are made and contractors appointed
- The differences between leases - some state that Gallions should pay for some works and in others the onus is upon the leaseholder.

Members have also met with our Revenue Manager to look at the arrears process and letters and have been asked to provide feedback on our reception leaflets, which give information to homeowners on things like insurance.

If you would like to join the Homeowner Consultation Panel please contact Marie Dunster on 0300 123 1237 or email mdunster@gallionsha.co.uk.

Estate charges for freeholders

In October and November, all freeholders who are liable to pay estate charges were sent their reconciliation invoices and estimates for the 2011-2012 service charge year. Panel members will be discussing these at their next meeting.

Thinking about home improvements?

Gallions' main contractor, Axis can help our leaseholders, shared owners and freeholders with home improvements.

Axis carry out a range of works for us such as replacement kitchens, bathrooms, rewiring and new windows and they can offer you the same sort of commercial rates that they charge us.

The volume of work that Axis does for us means they can buy materials at competitive prices and they can use the same local tradespeople.

Please contact Axis on 020 3260 3888 for more information.

Any arrangements made will be directly between Axis and the customer, including payment arrangement. Gallions has no involvement with, or responsibility for any such arrangements.

Taking part in major works

It can be beneficial for you to participate with Gallions' major works, and share in the economies of scale, even if it isn't required in your lease.

If you want to be involved in the replacement programme please contact us at homeownerteam@gallionsha.co.uk



Gallions Housing Association

New trees for Thamesmead

We recently worked with Trees for Cities to plant 12,000 new trees in Birchmere Park, Thamesmead. This will help create a natural screen against the busy Eastern Way, help local wildlife and make a big difference to the look of the park.

So make sure you check out the transformation! Visit www treesforcities.org or call 020 7587 1320 to find out more.



Thamesmead Furniture Recycle update

Thamesmead Furniture Recycle in Southmere Village, is currently closed until further notice, whilst a new location for the service is found. We will let you know when it is open for business again.

You Said We Did!

Thank you to Mr Finnegan of Thamesmead who suggested we change the recorded message on our main phone number so that the repairs number was given twice, not just once. We have now updated the message to give callers a bit more time to jot down all the digits. If you have any ideas or comments about our service just give us a call on 0300 123 1237 or fill in the form on our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk.

Tree works in Waterfield



We recently removed eight large trees in the Malthus Path and Ricardo Path area of Thamesmead. The trees had started to lift the path in the area and were creating trip hazards for residents. We will be re-planting some more trees in the grassed area in the new year that will keep the area looking good but will be safer for local people.

Get involved with Gallions

This summer the Gallions Resident Group (GRG) will be nominating residents to sit on Gallions Strategic Board and the Customer Services Committee. If you would like to know more please contact Jane Lester on 0300 123 1237 or email jlester@gallionsha.co.uk.

Fires are rubbish



Last year there were over 8,000 fires in London caused by rubbish. They start easily, and a large number of them are started deliberately. Dumped furniture, car tyres, scraps of wood, old mattresses, cardboard boxes - they don't just look bad but are a potential fire hazard and a target for arsonists too.

Team Gallions, our environmental services team, work 365 days a year to help clear dangerous rubbish. During the Bonfire Night celebrations the team removed eight tons of rubbish and bonfire materials to help keep our neighbourhoods safer.

If you notice anyone dumping rubbish in your area call us on 0300 123 1237 or your local council.

Well done Deborah!



Deborah Frimpong, Chair of Gallions Resident Group and Board Member, has recently chaired a Housing Quality Network (HQN) conference on scrutiny and co-regulation. She was in good company too, as the other guest speakers included Rafael Runco, Deputy Housing Ombudsman. What a fantastic achievement! If you would like to get involved with Gallions contact Helen Chambers on 0300 123 1237 or email hchambers@gallionsha.co.uk.

My home online

If you haven't tried out the great new way to check your rent account and repairs history yet make 2012 the year you give it a go! Visit www.gallionsha.co.uk/myhomeonline to register and you will be able to keep up to date with your rent statement, home and communal repairs and transfer requests 24 hours a day. Best of all it's totally free! If you need any help using the system call Anita Glover on 0300 123 1237.

Kidsview WORDSEARCH

We have hidden the names of six colours in this wordsearch. Find them all and you could win an art fun pack!



A	R	Q	R	W	V	E	L	Q	A	A	I	O
X	R	S	F	W	G	E	H	D	J	C	V	R
H	R	N	P	B	U	G	O	T	D	R	S	A
P	D	O	U	I	S	U	T	Y	E	T	K	N
B	T	C	M	X	T	Z	R	R	V	W	A	G
B	Y	N	P	U	R	P	L	E	I	H	O	E
C	C	X	K	Z	E	A	R	D	L	D	Y	F
J	B	W	N	L	M	P	L	O	K	E	J	I
S	C	O	N	S	E	D	O	F	L	U	H	H
I	A	L	Q	Y	W	I	E	R	D	L	T	B
Z	L	L	B	C	C	V	E	B	F	B	S	M
A	N	E	E	R	G	F	A	Q	D	W	U	E
R	T	Y	I	Y	N	I	L	O	M	P	L	H

PURPLE
RED
BLUE
GREEN
YELLOW
ORANGE

This competition is just for kids under 12. Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Anita Glover, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 28th February 2012. The winner will be selected at random.

Child's name:

Parent's name:

Address:

Telephone:

Well done to Avalon of Pulteney Close who was the winner of our last competition.